Northstar Industrial Supplies – AS-IS Checkout Process Map

Cart Review → Order Confirmation | Based on case story + questionnaire findings | High-level swimlane view

Actor / System	1. Context & Cart	2. Address & Delivery	3. Payment & Submit	4. Confirmation & After
Customer (Buyer)	• Sign in / select account • Add products to cart • Review cart lines & any availability messages (often unclear)	• Select / change shipping address • View delivery options • Options may appear/disappear or change date with no explanation	• Enter payment details • Click Submit • See pause / transient message • Page may return to review without order number • May click Submit again	• May see confirmation page • Receive email (sometimes delayed / differently worded) • Still unsure about shipments or next step • Call Support / Sales if uncertain
Northstar Systems	• Resolve customer context (account, locations, rules) • Price & eligibility checks • Cart persistence	• Recalculate availability & delivery options based on destination, qty, product, inventory source • Reasons not always returned or shown	• Validate → Payment request → Response • Order-creation attempt • States can diverge (auth ≠ order ≠ confirmation display)	• Create order record (if successful) • Trigger notification • Logging exists but correlation across systems is incomplete
Support / Finance / Ops	• Limited visibility into session path • Account data available after the fact	• Cannot always reconstruct exact delivery choices customer saw	• Finance: may not know if first attempt authorised • Support: case notes, sometimes order number, rarely payment ref	• Investigate after escalation • Different teams look at different identifiers • Duplicate risk assessed late

Key Decision / Branch Points

• Account / context selected correctly? → If no → pricing, payment eligibility, address list and rules may be wrong (Orion-type abandonment).
• Address / quantity / product change? → Delivery options recalculated; customer sees change without reason (Meridian / Harborline).
• Submit result uncertain? → Customer may resubmit; system may create 0, 1 or 2 orders; Support cannot always tell (Apex).
• Confirmation displayed but operational meaning unclear? → Customer still contacts Support (Harborline).

Failure / Uncertainty Paths (minimum three shown)

Path A – Uncertain submit (Apex): Submit → transient message / return to review → no order number → customer submits again → later one email arrives → Support finds one order but cannot confirm first payment attempt state → escalated as possible duplicate.
Path B – Delivery option loss (Meridian): Delivery choices shown → quantity or product change → option disappears or date moves → no explanation → customer cannot decide whether to split / substitute / accept → may abandon or call.
Path C – Context rejection (Orion): Account selected → address chosen → purchasing field rejected with generic "invalid" → customer changes account → cart remains but eligibility unclear → abandonment.

Pain-point callouts

• No shared end-to-end identifier for session + payment + order + support case.
• Customer-visible outcome can diverge from financial and order states.
• Delivery recalculation is often correct but opaque.
• "Successful checkout" is not defined the same way across roles.

Note: This map is intentionally high-level. Detailed technical behaviour that has not been confirmed by Technology questionnaires is not invented. Ownership boundaries and exact service sequence remain subject to confirmation.